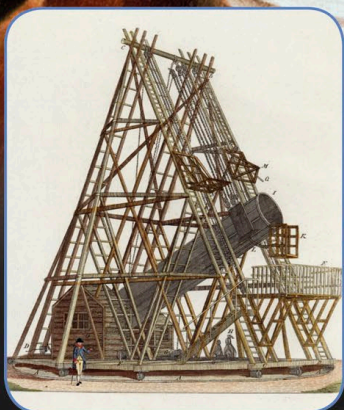


WILLIAM HERSCHEL

1738-1822

Astronomer William Herschel's discovery of Uranus in 1781, and two of its moons in 1787, made with a homemade telescope, increased the number of known planets from six to seven. In doing so, he doubled the size of our Solar System – Uranus was nearly twice as far from the Sun as Saturn, the sixth planet from the Sun. Appointed as the King's Astronomer by King George III, he also studied the structure of the Milky Way.

Herschel's sister, Caroline, was an astronomer, too. She **discovered eight comets**.



The Great 40-foot telescope, built and used by Herschel

DATA FILE



KEY DISCOVERIES: Identified Uranus and its moons Titania and Oberon



COUNTRY OF ORIGIN: Germany



YEARS OF DISCOVERIES: 1781 (Uranus) and 1787 (its moons)